

Floyd Civic Hub

An introduction for Floyd County residents: what it is, what it isn't, and where I hope it can go.

What it is

The Floyd Civic Hub is a new online space at floyd.civic.social, an interface for tracking what's happening in Floyd County government and for organizing as a community, whether that's responding to a decision in front of the Board, raising an issue that isn't being addressed, or building support around a project residents would like to see happen.

The Hub does two main things at launch:

1. **Keeps you in the loop on Floyd County government** — a single page where you can see what the Board of Supervisors is doing, with plain-language summaries of recent meetings as they come online and a daily email digest of new activity you can opt into.
2. **Gives the community a structured way to weigh in and organize.** Residents can respond to decisions in front of the Board, but also work in the other direction: any resident can submit a **proposal** for an issue they want addressed or a project they'd like to see happen. Once a proposal gathers enough citizen support to clear a threshold, it moves to an official vote. Votes stay open for a set period of time, and residents can vote **yes**, **no**, or **unsure**, along with sharing an optional comment about the proposal. When the vote closes, the Hub produces a short, readable **Civic Brief** summarizing where participating residents stand, and delivers it to the Board of Supervisors.

That's the starting point. It's a minimum viable product, small on purpose, so that further features can be shaped by real engagement and feedback.

Why I'm building this

Right now, if you want to engage with a county decision, your choices are: attend a meeting, call a supervisor, leave a Facebook comment, or speak at a public hearing. Each of these works for some people, but none of them give the Board, or the rest of us, a clear picture of where the community actually stands on a specific question.

And if you want to *raise* something, like an issue you don't think is getting attention or a project you'd like to see happen, the path is even less obvious. You can bring it up in public comment, post about it on Facebook, or talk to a supervisor one-on-one, but there's no real way to find out how many of your neighbors agree, or to build visible support for it over time.

On top of that, just keeping up with what's happening in county government is its own job. Agendas, minutes, and meeting recordings live on the county website, but tracking them takes time most of us don't have. The result is that civic life in Floyd often ends up scattered across meeting minutes, separate websites, and Facebook threads. None of these were built for the job.

The Floyd Civic Hub is an attempt to build something purpose-built for productive civic engagement in Floyd County: a calm, structured place to follow local government, contribute meaningfully to decisions the Board is making, and organize the community around the issues and projects residents themselves want to put on the table.

What this is not

A few things worth being clear about upfront, because the web address ([civic.social](#)) can be misleading.

This is not a social network. No friends list, no follower counts, no endless scroll, no algorithm trying to keep you on the site. There's no open comment war zone. Input is structured (your position, your main concern, an optional suggestion), and the system aggregates it. It's designed for thinking together, not for the dynamics that make Facebook what it is.

This is not a replacement for the county website. [floydcova.gov](#) is and should remain the primary, authoritative source for official county information. The Hub references and links back to it, and pulls in meeting information from it, rather than competing with it.

This is not an official government project. The Hub is independent, non-partisan, and not operated by the county, any campaign, or any advocacy group. The Board of Supervisors is being kept informed and will receive Civic Briefs, but they are not being asked to operate or maintain any of this.

The bigger picture: Civic.Social

The Floyd Hub is the first real deployment of a larger project called **Civic.Social**, an effort to build open, community-run digital infrastructure for civic participation. The premise is simple: civic life is too important to depend on commercial social media platforms whose incentives have very little to do with helping communities deliberate well or hold government accountable. Communities deserve purpose-built infrastructure they actually govern.

Civic.Social is being developed as a non-profit initiative under the Mosaic Foundation, a Virginia non-stock corporation currently in the process of obtaining 501(c)(3) status. The software is open, the data isn't sold, and the long-term intention is for each community's Hub to be governed by that community.

Floyd is the proving ground. If the model works here, the same software can be picked up by other communities. But the priority right now is making it genuinely useful for Floyd, not building digital civic infrastructure in the abstract.

Where this could grow — with your input

The MVP is intentionally narrow. But the Hub is designed to grow, and the direction it grows in should come from the community. Some directions that are possible if there's interest:

- **A searchable county bulletin board** — a central place for the timely notices that currently live in scattered Facebook pages: weather alerts, burn bans, road closures, school closures, utility outages, public health advisories.
- **Iterative, more sophisticated deliberation processes** — multi-round consultations, structured consensus-building, or citizen assemblies on complex issues, not just up-or-down polls.
- **Direct supervisor updates** — an optional channel for Board members to post short updates to residents outside of meeting minutes and Facebook.
- **Community resource tools** — things like a local lending library or tool library coordinated through the Hub, if that's something residents would actually use.
- **Deeper participation features** — supervisor Q&A threads, public comment periods on draft ordinances, or other tools that fit how Floyd actually likes to do civic business.

These are illustrative, not promised. The current Civic Hub is just a foundation. What new features get built should reflect what Floyd County residents actually want, not just what I happen to think as the admin of the Floyd Civic Hub.

What I'd ask of you

If you have time, the most useful things you can do are:

- **Take a look at floyd.civic.social.** This is a soft launch: the site is live, and I'm gathering initial feedback before sharing it more widely with the community. Tell me what you like, what's confusing, what's missing, and what feels off.
- **Create an account on the Hub** so you can receive the daily email digest of new county activity, and let me know how that experience feels.
- **Tell me what you wish worked better** in terms of how Floyd County government and residents communicate. What's broken? What would actually help?
- **Suggest what the Hub should do next.** If there's a feature on the list above that matters to you, or one I haven't thought of, I want to hear it.
- **Share it with a few people you think could give thoughtful feedback** on the soft launch version of the site (which could include passing this document along to them). I'd like to work out any bugs before sharing it more widely.

You can send feedback by email to contact@civic.social, or use the **Feedback** item in the site menu at floyd.civic.social to leave it directly through the Hub.

This is the beginning of something I hope to build with Floyd over the long term, not something I'm dropping in and walking away from. I'd much rather hear hard feedback now than build in the wrong direction.

Who's behind this

I'm **Adam Lake**, a Floyd County resident of 25 years, a Virginia Tech graduate, and a technologist with a decade of experience in information technology. I started Civic.Social out of a belief that American democracy works best when local communities and their elected officials can communicate, deliberate, and decide together, and that local governance deserves real digital infrastructure fit for purpose.

Part of what motivates this work is the conviction that we actually agree on more than the platforms shaping our public conversation would have us think. Americans are pushed into perceived disagreement by environments designed for outrage and engagement, not for understanding. Consensus-building is community-building, and helping neighbors hear each other and bridge across perceived difference is part of what local civic infrastructure should do.

If you'd like to talk, share feedback, or get involved, please reach out.

Adam Lake — adam@civic.social

The Floyd Civic Hub is a pilot deployment of the Civic.Social Hub framework, a project of the Mosaic Foundation.